

01 SMALL TALK

When was the last time you bought a gift for your parents?

When you eat out with friends, do you split the bill equally or pay for what you ordered?

Before you go shopping, do you set a budget first, or just buy what you like?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"I am living with my family since born."~~

✓ "I've lived with my family since I was born."

태어난 뒤 지금까지 쭉 이어진 일이라 현재완료(I've lived)를 쓰고, since 뒤엔 시점(I was born)이 와요.

② ~~"My parent is very strict."~~

✓ "My parents are very strict."

보통 부모님은 두 분이라 복수 parents가 자연스러워요. 한 분만 가리킬 땐 my mom / my dad로 꼭 집어요.

③ ~~"My father is scary."~~

✓ "My dad is kind of intimidating."

scary는 귀신·공포영화 느낌이에요. 사람이 어렵고 위압적이면 intimidating이 자연스러워요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 질문에 A 또는 B 손가락으로 표시. 마음에 드는 거 하나만 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Quick Choice (5분)

1 For a parent's gift, do you prefer A) one group gift together, or B) each person gives separately?

2 Should siblings split the cost A) equally for everyone, or B) by what each person can afford?

3 Is it better to A) talk about the budget openly, or B) keep your money situation private?

4 Do you usually A) plan a gift early, or B) decide at the last minute?

FAMILY · MAIN DISCUSSION

Parent Gift Budgets — Split Equally or Adjust Fairly?

🇰🇷 BACKGROUND

부모님 선물 예산을 형제끼리 똑같이 나눌지, 각자 상황에 맞게 조정할지는 생각보다 민감한 문제예요. 같은 마음이어도 월급, 생활비, 결혼 여부, 거주 상황이 다르면 부담이 다르게 느껴질 수 있어요. 똑같이 내면 갈굼하지만 누군가에게는 무리일 수 있고, 다르게 내면 공평하지 않다는 느낌이 생길 수 있죠. 그래서 선물보다 먼저 필요한 건 서로의 형편을 편하게 말할 수 있는 분위기에요.

📖 READ BEFORE WE TALK

Splitting a parent's gift budget sounds simple, until everyone's situation is different. Equal shares can feel clean and fair, because no one has to calculate emotions. But equal is not always easy. One sibling may have higher rent, a lower income, children, or loans. Adjusting by situation can feel kinder, but it can also create quiet resentment if people feel their effort is being measured unfairly. The hard part is separating love from money. A family gift works best when people can talk honestly about the budget before the gift becomes a test of who cares more.

💡 WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

split it equally — 똑같이 나누다

chip in — 돈을 조금씩 보태다

set a budget — 예산을 정하다

money is a bit tight — 돈이 좀 빠듯하다

fair isn't always equal — 공평한 게 늘 똑같은 건 아니다

a group gift — 합동 선물

🗣️ TRY THESE PHRASES

I'd say splitting equally is better because it keeps things simple and fair.

It depends on the situation, but usually adjusting by each person's budget feels kinder.

It starts to feel unfair when one person earns much more but pays the same as someone who has very little.

Honestly, the problem shows up when someone is struggling — and still pays a full share.

⚡ EASY ENTRY

- 1 When you give your parents a gift, are you more of a 'cash in an envelope' or a 'pick out a present' person?
- 2 When was the last time you and your siblings chipped in together for a family gift? What was it for?
- 3 Quick — for your parents' next gift, would you pick cash, an experience like a trip or dinner, or a physical present?
- 4 What's your usual move when the family chat starts planning a parent's birthday gift — jump in first, wait to be asked, or stay quiet?

🗣️ MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. When you and your siblings (or family) buy a gift together, is it better to split equally or adjust by each person's situation?

↳ *I'd say splitting equally is better because it keeps things simple and fair.*

↳ *It depends on the situation, but usually adjusting by each person's budget feels kinder.*

Q2. When does splitting equally start to feel unfair to you?

↳ *It starts to feel unfair when one person earns much more but pays the same as someone who has very little.*

↳ *Honestly, the problem shows up when someone is struggling — and still pays a full share.*

Q3. Would you feel comfortable telling your family your budget is tight this time? Why or why not?

↳ *In my case, telling my family is easy because we trust each other.*

↳ *The thing is, it's hard for me to say my budget is tight, because I don't want to look cheap.*

Q4. Should the person who earns more naturally pay more? Why or why not?

↳ *I lean more toward the higher earner paying a bit more, because they can afford it more easily.*

↳ *The way I see it, paying more should be a choice, not a rule based on salary.*

Q5. How can siblings keep a gift from feeling like a competition?

↳ *One way to avoid competition is to make it one group gift instead of separate ones.*

↳ *What helps is talking about the budget first, so no one feels pressure to spend more.*